ST. MONICA MEMORIAL SCHOOLS
Beyond Learning

TEACHING AND LEARNING POLICY

Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to improve continuously the learning and achievement of students at St. Monica Memorial School.

It applies to all members of the school community but especially to administration and members of the teaching staff.

Since knowledge about effective teaching and promoting good learning is increasing and being refined continually, this policy does not provide a manual of what should be done. It expresses the general principles that should inform good teaching and learning within the school and to promote continuous improvement.

Underpinning this policy is the principle that teaching must not undermine fundamental Kenyan values or discriminate against students on the basis of protected characteristics.

Good teaching will enable students to make good progress through effective planning and regular assessment, use of effective resources, and the creation of a learning environment conducive to learning. Students will be encouraged to be self-motivated and to achieve responsibility.

There is considerable overlap between policies which aim to ensure good teaching and those which systematically promote good learning. However, this policy does separate them in order to distinguish between teaching, which is directly under the control of teachers, and learning, which the school promotes but which is done by the students.

Learning

Purpose

The purpose of the learning aspect of the policy is to ensure that the learning of students is systematically supported, guided, and encouraged so that they become effective learners; understanding how they learn, possessing a range of effective study techniques, and taking responsibility for their own learning. All staff are responsible for creating the conditions for good learning.

Conditions for Good Learning

Good learning occurs when the conditions are right for it to do so. Students can be encouraged or discouraged, enabled or disabled from learning by the management of the school and learning environment.

The conditions for learning are:

1. A climate within the school and the individual classroom that is:
    - Orderly
    - Characterized by mutual respect between teachers and learners
    - Confidence-enhancing and challenging
2. A commitment to high expectations shared by teachers and all students.
3. Attention to the different learning styles of students.

    We are aware that there are various ways of learning, but we accept the importance of recognizing that learning styles differ and that students who are able to use their own learning style increase in confidence and learn more effectively.

4. Effective and prompt assessment of progress.
5. Marking and feedback, whether verbal and informal or written and formal, which encourages, is related to understood criteria and which shows the students clearly what is required to improve.
6. Effective lines with parents to encourage high aspirations for their children in order to improve parents' understanding of the content purpose and procedures of the teaching in the school, and to encourage parents to assist the school in developing their children. As part of this we:-

- Give parents information on courses, homework, and examination via our prospectus, website, presentation evenings, calendar, reports, grade cards, parents' meetings, and full reports.
- Ensure that parents receive warnings of any of their child's shortcomings as early as possible and are also given information of good work that the child has done as soon as possible, and
- Provide parents with easy ways to communicate concerns, interests, or questions.

7. Monitoring, evaluation, and review of the attitudes and achievements of individuals and groups which identifies key success factors and implements plans based on the process of review.

Special Educational Needs and Disabilities (including Additional Learning Needs)

All these conditions have to be in place for students with special educational needs and disabilities / additional learning needs to thrive. It is particularly important to encourage aspiration and to make appropriate adjustments to make learning accessible. This will involve close cooperation with our SENCO and support staff. It may involve the use of various aids to access (mechanical and technological) and adjustments to lesson and classroom organization.

Responsibilities

Headteacher, Senior Management Team

To create the conditions for good learning throughout our school, we will:

- Promote learning to parents and students.
- Promote whole-school approaches that encourage continuous improvement among students.
- Monitor attitudes to learning across the school, by subject and by groups of students.
- Monitor achievement across the school, by subject and by groups of students.
- Evaluate findings and develop approaches to improve attitudes and achievement.

Continuously.

- Establish a programme to develop students' study skills and their understanding of their own learning throughout discrete units of the
- Intervene where attitudes and attainment are low.
- Ensure that all staff are appropriately trained, and are fit and competent to teach in the programmes of study that they are directed to participate in, and
- Implement arrangements for the regular monitoring and review of the policy and strategies.

The Deputy Head Academic

Is responsible for ensuring the implementation of the policy and reporting annually on its progress to the administration.

Head of Department

To create the conditions for good learning with their subject they will:

- Inspire students' interest in the subject by promoting it in every way.
- Be a leader to staff in the subject in encouraging them to promote the subject and inspire students with an interest in it.
- Be a leader of the staff in subject in understanding students' learning and using this understanding by applying it to their lessons; and
- Monitor the attitudes and achievements of the whole school and groups of students in the subject.
- Develop approaches to improve attitudes and achievement continuously.
- Support staff teaching the subject to create the conditions for learning
- Intervene where students' attitudes and attainment in the subject are low;
- devise materials to assist students to meet coursework and examination requirements, and
- Ensure that all staff are appropriately trained in relevant teaching learning strategies and are competent to teach their subjects.

Heads of Year

The responsibility of pastoral staff in their pastoral role, is to encourage positive attitudes and aspirations among students and help them to develop the skills for study and good work habits; and

- Liaise with parents to improve attitudes advise on courses and encourage high aspirations

Classroom Staff

Classroom staff are responsible for creating conditions for good learning with the groups for which they are responsible. They will:

- Demonstrate high aspirations for students and make high demands of them in terms of their efforts, interest in their work and their ability to think and learn independently,
- Enable students to make progress according to their ability so that they acquire new knowledge, increase their understanding and develop their skills in the subjects being taught;
- Assist students in developing skills of organisation and willingness to persevere when work is hard.
- Report back to students on their progress in ways that celebrate success and encourage them to address problems and aspire to continuous improvement;
- Evaluate the commitment and enthusiasm of students and continually review and modify teaching approaches to take account of these reviews;
- Ensure that they keep up-to-date with appropriate learning learning and teaching strategies and techniques in their subject(s)

Teaching

The purpose of this policy with regard to teaching is to ensure that teaching in the school is as good as possible and to set out the standards expected and the responsibilities of all members of the school community to meeting them. Teaching must enable all students to acquire new knowledge and make good progress.

BOM

It is the responsibility of the BOM to monitor this policy and to ensure that it is regularly reviewed. In particular the BOM will monitor:

- The outcomes of the policy in terms of results and add value in examination and the numbers of students continuing to pursue their education,
- The outcomes of observation conducted by team leaders and others,
- The comments of inspectors,
- The comments of parents.

Headteacher, Senior Management Team

The responsibilities of the Headteacher and the Senior Management Team (SMT) are to set the objectives for teaching; to ensure that a system is in place to support and improve teaching and learning; and to inspire teachers to improve teaching continuously. They will:

- Ensure that teaching can take place within an ordered environment;
- Ensure that team leaders are fulfilling their role in improving teaching and leading their teams in that improvement;
- Ensure that a system is in place to spread good practice across the school;
- Ensure that the organisation of the school day and year, support good teaching;

- Ensure that other school policies and system support this policy (Staff Appraisal procedures; Resource Management; Homework and Staff Competency procedures);
- Monitor the effectiveness of teaching; and
- Intervene where teaching falls below the standards expected.

Heads of Department

The responsibilities of Heads of Department is to lead and inspire their team to improve their teaching; to ensure that the systems within the subject promote good teaching; and to be responsible for the quality of teaching in the subject. They will:

- Provide schemes of work and recommendations for teaching approaches that reflect best practice nationally;
- Organise teaching materials and resources the timetable for the subject and the deployment of staff to best effect;
- Monitor and evaluate teaching in the subject;
- Intervene where teaching falls below the standard required.
- Ensure that good practice is spread between teachers of the subject;
- Use the staff appraisal procedures of the school to promote the development of teachers in the subject, and
- Ensure that cover staff are fully aware of their responsibilities and the work they are expected to cover with the class and to ensure that they are informed, supported and fulfill the teacher requirements of the class.

Classroom Teachers

The responsibility of classroom teacher is to improve continuously their knowledge, skills and understanding of teaching and to apply these consistently and conscientiously. They will:

- Update regularly their subject knowledge in order to demonstrate good subject knowledge and understanding;
- Update regularly their knowledge of examination requirements;
- Update their knowledge of pedagogy i.e. the understanding of children's learning and the appropriate way of teaching to make the most of this knowledge;
- Update their personal mastery of the technology available to support teaching;
- Create the appropriate climate for learning within their classroom-utilising appropriate behavior management strategies and encouraging students to act responsibly;
- Will not discriminate against students in any way;
- Assess the abilities, aptitudes, learning styles and personality of the students in each group and organise and plan lesson appropriately taking these into account;
- Provide effective reports on progress to students and parents.
- Use effectively resources of a good quality, quantities and range;

- Share with colleagues within and outside the subject ideas on how to improve teaching; and
- Liaise with support and cover teachers to ensure continuity of work for their classes and progress by students requiring additional support.

Support staff

Support staff are responsible for ensuring that there is continuity between the work planned by the class teacher and the work which they do with the individual. They will:

- Make sure that they are aware how the work they are doing fits into the programme for the class,
- Ensure that where possible they liaise with the class teacher.

Pastoral staff

The responsibility of pastoral staff in regard to teaching is to monitor the progress of students for whom they are responsible and to liaise on their progress with other staff and parents. They will:

- Monitor students' results across all subjects to see whether there are any anomalies and bring to the attention of other staff.
- Heads of Year/Assistant Heads will monitor students' results against predicted performance and bring under- or over-performance to the attention of other staff.
- Heads of the year will work with students and their parents to ensure that subjects choices are made that will maximize students achievement; and
- Heads of year will share in devising a study-skills programme that will enable students to plan and schedule work effectively and in particular prepare for examination and coursework.

Schemes of Work

Good teaching starts with good schemes of work. Heads of department will ensure that schemes of work:

- Take full account of the National Curriculum where applicable, but are not limited by it,
- Specify content and Methodology in accordance with best practice.
- Describe the resources needed and available for each topic
- Describe appropriate approaches to topics
- Provide differentiation
- Specify approaches to assessment and reporting to students and parents.

Lesson Planning

The precise approach to lesson planning will vary from subject to subject and it is impractical to lay down precise rules that will cover every possibility. However, it is expected that lessons will include planning that will cover:

- Ensure pace and shape in lesson;
- Ensuring that there are varying opportunities for learning eg interactive work; work with ICT; group work; individual study and report;
- Identifying work that is suitable for the student's age, abilities, learning styles and personality types. This is not only a matter of making adjustments for students with disabilities but also covers students with no disability but whose style of learning differs from that of others in the group or that of the teacher; and
- Arrangements of assessment of learning formal or informal that can lead into effective feedback to students and shape the teachers planning for ensuring lessons.